THE URBAN PLATE

Table Ordering System - Project Overview

Web application | HTML, CSS and JavaScript | Portfolio project

What it is

A single-file web app (one HTML file) that lets guests order from their table, while the waiter, kitchen and manager each get their own screen. It runs in any modern browser with no installation. Guests open a table with a code, browse a picture menu, send orders straight to the kitchen, track them, pay, earn loyalty points and play games while they wait.

Screen	Who uses it	Main purpose
Customer	Guests at a table	Open table, order, track, pay, rewards, games, info
Waiter	Floor staff	Approve table requests, serve ready food, close paid tables
Kitchen	Chefs	Receive orders directly, mark them preparing / ready
Manager	Owner / manager	Sales, menu, offers, tables and QR codes, reports, settings

Customer experience

Opening a table

- Guest scans the table tag (QR) or picks a table and sends a request; the waiter confirms it and a table code is issued.
- Several guests at one table share the same code and one bill.
- Optional customer account (phone number and PIN) to collect points; login is remembered on the device.

Ordering and paying

- Menu with category tabs (Mains, Sides, Drinks, Desserts), search, a Popular Now row, and a detail sheet with customise switches (extra spicy, no onions, extra sauce, pack to go).
- A free-text special-request note travels with the order to the waiter and kitchen.
- Live order tracker per order (Sent to Kitchen, Preparing, Ready, Served), a table bill, and payment options: Cash, Card, Apple Pay, Google Pay, PayPal.
- A sound alert tells the customer when their order moves forward. Rate the waiter after paying; review individual dishes.

Rewards and extras

- Loyalty: customers earn points on every bill and spend them on offers such as percentage or fixed discounts. The manager can edit the offers.

- Games while waiting: Memory Match and a 10-second Tap Challenge with scores.
- Info tab with Wi-Fi details, opening hours, address, phone and about text.

Staff screens

Waiter

- Tables with code and running bill, table requests to approve, orders in the kitchen, and orders ready to serve.
- Waiter selector (Nimal, Kasun, Ayesha) so ratings go to the right person.
- Sound alert for a new table request, a customer call, or an order that is ready to serve.

Kitchen

- Two-column board: New orders and Preparing, with customer notes and a late warning at 15 minutes.
- Orders arrive directly from customers, with a triple-beep alert for each new order.

Manager

- Dashboard: today, week and month earnings, total revenue, paid bills, average bill, active orders, open balance, plus Live Orders, Payments and Top Dishes tables.
- Menu and photos: upload real photos and add new dishes (name, price, category, tag, description).
- Offers and loyalty, Tables and QR codes, Reports (waiter ratings, notifications), Settings (PINs, Wi-Fi, restaurant info).
- Print report, Export CSV, Load sample data, Clear history.

Order flow: customer, kitchen, waiter, customer

Step	What happens
1. Customer	Customer sends the order from the table
2. Kitchen	Order arrives at the kitchen (Sent to Kitchen); the chef starts Preparing
3. Ready	Chef marks it Ready; the waiter is alerted
4. Waiter	Waiter brings the food and marks it Served
5. Customer	Customer sees Served, enjoys the meal and pays; waiter closes the table

Technical notes

- One HTML file with built-in CSS and JavaScript; no libraries or server. Screens: #customer, #waiter, #kitchen, #manager.
- 6 tables by default; staff roles are protected by PINs that the manager can change in Settings.
- Dark glass-style design with an orange accent; all icons are inline SVG.

Limitations to plan for

- Data is stored in the browser (localStorage). Screens stay in sync only when open in the same browser, so real phones at real tables need a backend (for example Firebase or Supabase).
- PINs and customer logins are checked in the browser, so they are not secure for a public deployment.
- Payment buttons record the payment method but do not process real payments.
- Sound alerts work only while the page is open, and need one tap after loading.

Suggested next steps

- Add a backend so orders sync across devices.
- Replace the drawn dish illustrations with real photos.
- Server-side staff login and real payment integration.